

9. High-Difficulty Inheritance and Practical Operation

Observation-based full English reconstruction of the revised Japanese chapter

ONE-LINE SUMMARY In high-difficulty inheritance, theoretical success and practical success can diverge sharply. Candidate structure, order, workload, and recovery cost must be managed together with success rate.

SCOPE NOTE This edition preserves the revised 9-5-5A research history and separates in-game Observation, External Information, Historical Testimony, Interpretation, and Unknown.

9-1. The High-Difficulty Inheritance Problem

ONE-LINE SUMMARY A setup that works in theory may fail in practice when order, candidate contamination, performance retention, and work time become simultaneous requirements.

High-difficulty inheritance in Rune Factory 4 Special and Rune Factory 5 involves more than a single successful inheritance result. Candidate count, candidate order, unwanted candidates, retention of effective performance, occupied arrangement slots, Auto Arrange contamination, reset count, and work time can all become problems at once.

A setup with a nominal 25% success rate may become far more burdensome when correct order, performance retention, and exclusion of unwanted candidates are all required. Conversely, candidate-count control, near-fixed behavior, and manipulation with duplicate materials can sometimes improve practical outcomes substantially.

Practical operation therefore has to manage the workload itself, not only a simple expected probability.

- Candidate count
- Candidate order
- Unwanted candidate contamination
- Effective performance retention
- Arrangement-slot occupancy
- Auto Arrange contamination
- Reset count
- Work time

9-2. Split-Save Strategy

ONE-LINE SUMMARY Split saves do not raise the probability of success; they reduce the rollback range after failure and can sharply lower expected retries and work time.

Repeated save-and-load cycles become expensive when Messhilitite inheritance, Object X ordering, simultaneous candidate requirements, Recursive Processing, and arrangement-slot adjustment are handled together.

Saving before each major stage - before inserting materials, upgrading, arranging, or inheriting - limits how much work must be repeated. This can reduce material recollection, reforging, reset time, and mental load.

In practice, loss per failure (recovery cost) may affect total efficiency more strongly than the nominal success rate.

- Save before material insertion
- Save before upgrading
- Save before arrangement
- Save before inheritance

9-3. Candidate-Count Control

ONE-LINE SUMMARY Growth in candidate count N causes combinatorial expansion and a steep increase in practical workload, making control of candidate structure a central task.

Within the observations used for this chapter, behavior near $N \leq 3$ was comparatively easy to keep close to fixed. Near $N \geq 4$, candidate competition, order variability, more combinations, and unwanted candidates may become more likely.

Duplicate-material manipulation, removal of unnecessary candidates, arrangement-slot compression, and avoidance of Auto Arrange can help preserve the candidate structure. A high nominal success rate is not sufficient if order, performance, or candidate exclusion becomes difficult.

- Raise success rate where useful
- Keep the candidate structure from collapsing
- Treat $N \leq 3$ and $N \geq 4$ as observation-based working regions, not universal internal boundaries

BOUNDARY The N regions above are practical observations under the tested conditions. They do not establish a universal internal threshold.

9-4. Practical Build Strategy

ONE-LINE SUMMARY The theoretical optimum is not always the practical optimum; optimization that accepts deliberate compromises can be the rational choice.

A practical build should weigh success rate, work time, material cost, appearance, resident suitability, and long-term usability. Adding theoretical performance can increase the candidate count so much that reset workload overwhelms the gain.

Construction difficulty, expected attempts, real time, and mental load therefore belong in the decision. A stable and reproducible build may have more practical value than a nominally strongest one.

Material collection also matters. Mealy Apples, Double Steel, and Glitter Augite are examples of materials that may be required in quantity.

- Theoretical maximum
- Practical reproducibility
- Material cost
- Real-time workload
- Mental load

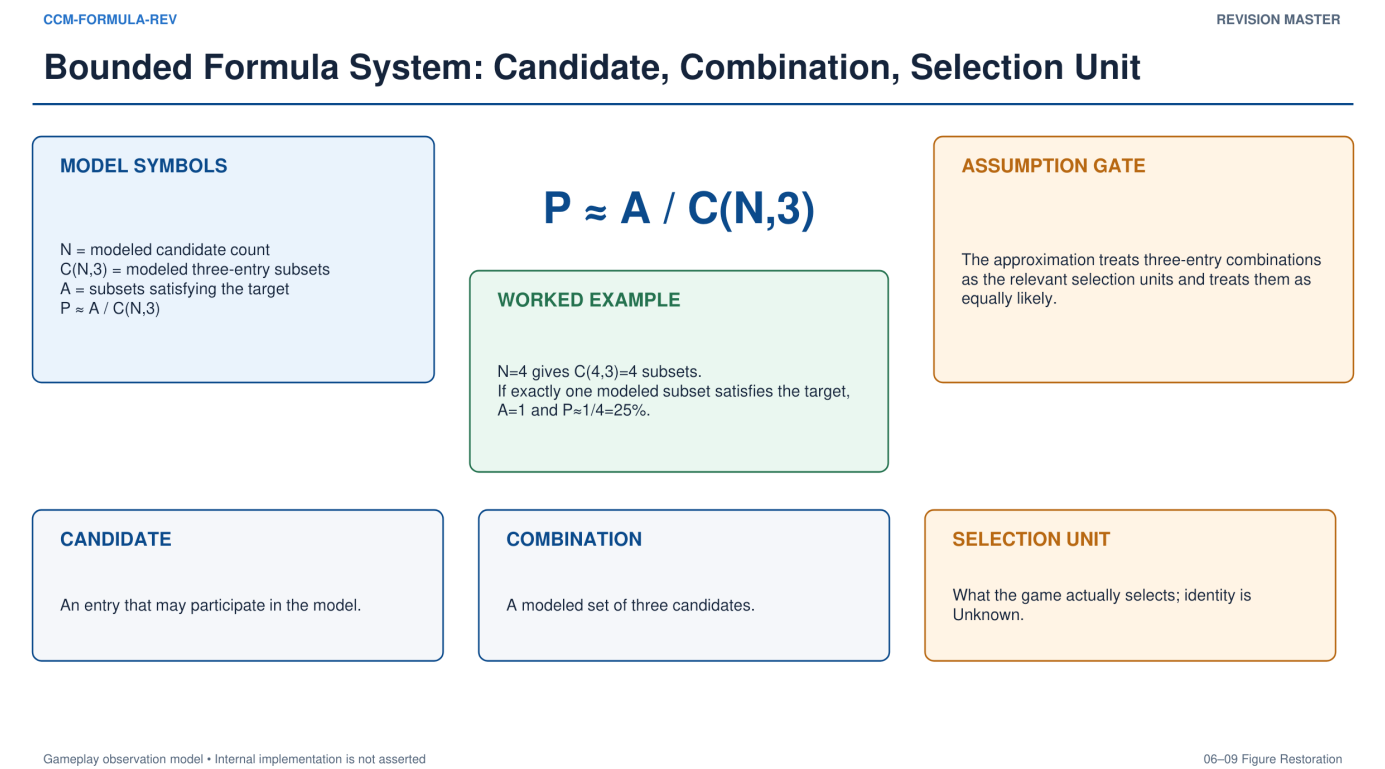
9-5. Optimizing Resident Equipment

ONE-LINE SUMMARY Resident equipment often values stability, general utility, visual fit, and mass producibility more than maximum performance.

Resident equipment needs a different optimization philosophy from protagonist equipment. AI behavior, hit consistency, status ailments, durability, appearance, and character identity can all matter.

This chapter deliberately combines observations, practical interpretation, hypotheses, and role-play considerations. Those layers should not be treated as equal evidence.

Layer	Example
Observation	Starting weapon / elemental resistance
Practical interpretation	Behavior tendency / operational role
Hypothesis	AI performance / possible body-size effect
Role-play consideration	Visual fit / consistency with the setting



BOUNDARY AI behavior and body-size effects include hypothesis-level organization based on observation and play experience.

9-5-1. Optimization Philosophy for Resident Equipment

ONE-LINE SUMMARY Unlike protagonist equipment, resident equipment should prioritize stable operation, reproducibility, AI usability, and visual coherence.

Protagonist builds can prioritize peak damage, high-difficulty inheritance, or burst performance. Resident builds often benefit more from stability, versatility, ease of use, and consistency with the character and setting.

Headgear may be mechanically strong while changing a character's appearance too much. When producing many sets, inheritance difficulty, material cost, and reproducibility also become important. Maximum performance is therefore not always the best resident-equipment target.

9-5-2. Competition Between Tandem Smithing and Performance Inheritance (RF5 Only)

ONE-LINE SUMMARY In RF5, Tandem Smithing can multiply the selection burden of performance inheritance and therefore requires a deliberate strategy.

When Tandem Smithing is combined with performance inheritance, the practical expectation is approximately the probability of successful performance inheritance multiplied by the probability of obtaining the desired Tandem Smithing result.

Messhilite inheritance, difficult arrangements, candidate-count growth, and arrangement-slot variation can increase the required attempts sharply.

- Pursue both results
- Separate Tandem Smithing from performance inheritance
- Accept a non-optimal Tandem result
- Do not rely on the Tandem result

9-5-3. Provisional Classification of Resident Smithing Effects

ONE-LINE SUMMARY A provisional model classifies reported resident-smithing effects and estimates the draw share of each group.

This classification is based on effect information recorded in sources such as community wikis. AI assistance was used for grouping; the counts and percentages were manually rechecked.

Effect group	Residents	Estimated share	Examples
INT-related	8	33.30%	Priscilla, Ludmila, etc.
STR-related	4	16.70%	Fuuka, Reinhard, etc.
VIT-related	4	16.70%	Lucy, etc.
CRIT-related	4	16.70%	Scarlett, etc.
Stun-related	3	12.50%	Beatrice, etc.
Special	1	4.20%	Palmo
Total	24	-	-

BOUNDARY Internal selection rules, weights, and appearance conditions remain unresolved. The table is a provisional calculation, not proof of the internal lottery.

Master: CUMULATIVE-PROBABILITY-CURRENT | Source anchor: Japanese Canonical p.3

REUSE / TRANSLATE

Success Probability Curve

As the candidate pool expands, successful combinations become increasingly diluted, reducing the probability of obtaining a specific inheritance result.

The graph plots Success Probability (log scale, 0.1% to 100%) against Candidate Count (N). It is divided into three regions: Stable Region (N=3 to 4), Candidate Explosion (N=5 to 6), and Combination Dilution (N=7 to 8). The probability drops sharply as N increases. Below the graph, a conceptual illustration shows that more candidates lead to more possible combinations, which in turn leads to a lower chance of obtaining a specific combination.

Candidate Count (N)	Combinations	Success Probability
3	1 Combination	100%
4	4 Combinations	25%
5	10 Combinations	10%
6	20 Combinations	5%
7	35 Combinations	2.86%
8	54 Combinations	1.85%

Key Takeaway

Increasing the candidate count expands the combination space much faster than most players intuitively expect. As a result, even when the desired inheritance remains possible, its relative probability rapidly decreases because it occupies a smaller fraction of all possible combinations.

Note: $N = 8$ represents a highly specialized inheritance scenario that generally requires intentional recursive inheritance planning and is primarily applicable to accessories and footwear. It is included here only as a conceptual example illustrating how rapidly the combination space expands as candidate count increases.

Conceptual Illustration based on the Candidate Count Model.

The curve illustrates the general relationship between candidate count and inheritance success probability and is not intended to represent exact gameplay values.

The source figure retains the probability curve, trial multipliers, expected-attempt context, and planning interpretation.

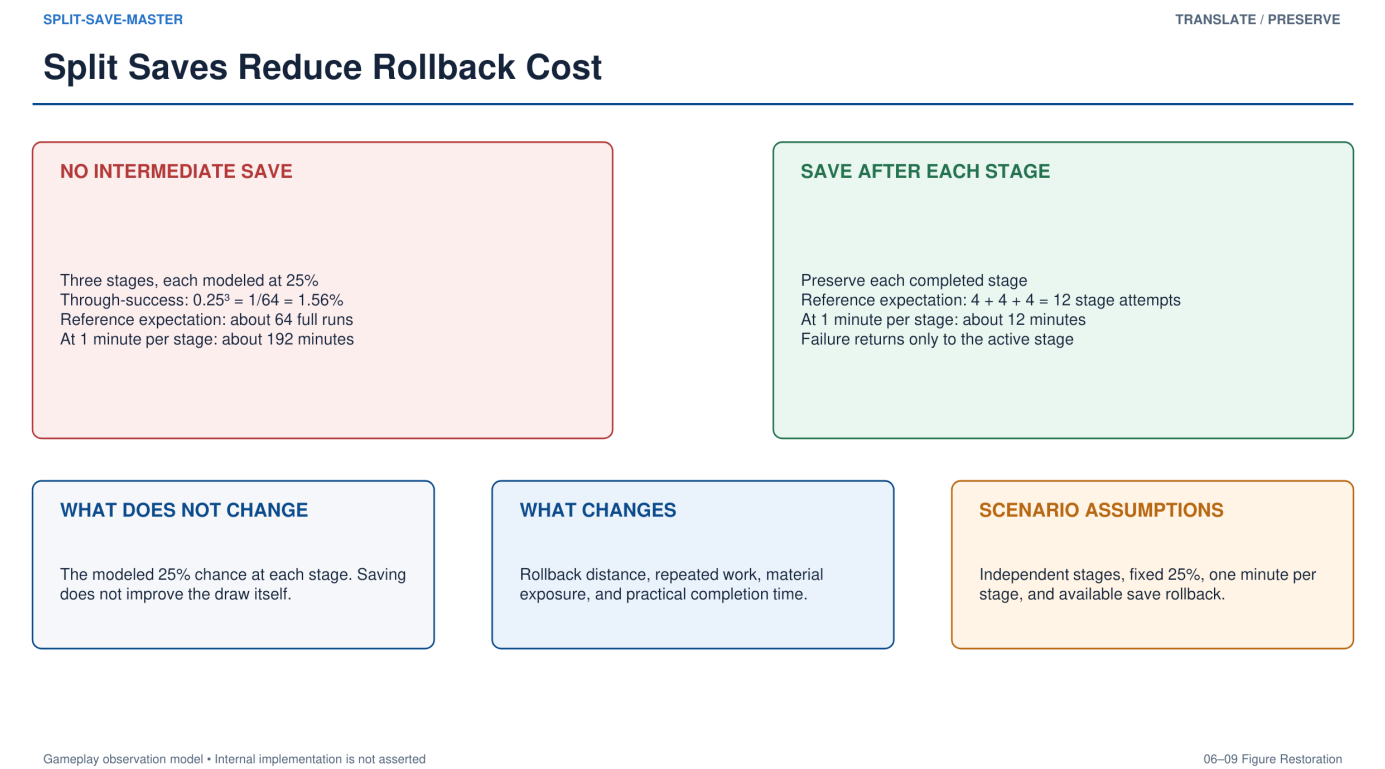
Mathematical planning chart only. Fixed p and independence are explicit assumptions; inheritance mechanism is outside this figure.

SOURCE DETAIL + CURRENT BOUNDARY

06-09 Figure Restoration

Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.

Current English integration - figure authority migrated from the Japanese Canonical inventory.



Placement caption

Split-save expected-attempt reduction model
Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.

9-5-4. Practical Value of Resident Smithing

ONE-LINE SUMMARY Given unstable availability and selection cost, targeting a practical gain such as ATK or M.ATK may be more efficient than full optimization.

Some effects, such as an INT increase, may modify equipment-side parameters rather than the wearer's underlying ability. A large nominal multiplier may therefore have limited practical impact.

Resident availability, friendship requirements, smithing resets, and competition with Messhilite inheritance can make theoretical optimization very expensive. Within the practical scope considered here, narrowing the goal to ATK or M.ATK gains is often a reasonable cost-benefit choice.

9-5-5. Practical Protagonist Equipment Examples

ONE-LINE SUMMARY The examples optimize by use case, considering handling, reproducibility, and material cost in addition to theoretical performance.

Different tasks - ordinary combat, difficult battles, material collection, maze runs, crafting, and skill training - require different properties. The examples therefore mix theoretical construction, practical adjustment, and role-play rather than claiming one complete optimum.

Shoes and accessories are swapped frequently. Appearance bases can improve visibility and identification. Accessories are also vulnerable to Performance-Source Contamination, Auto Arrange, and candidate growth through Recursive Processing, so some examples deliberately reduce arrangement slots or prioritize reproducibility.

Stable, mass-production-oriented, practical, and hobby builds coexist below. Free slots can be adapted for status resistance, RP support, elemental resistance, drop-rate support, appearance, or role-play.

BOUNDARY The former blanket understanding that dual blades and fists cannot benefit from shields is superseded by 9-5-5A below.

9-5-5A. Dual Blades, Fists, and Shield Performance: Updating the Former Understanding

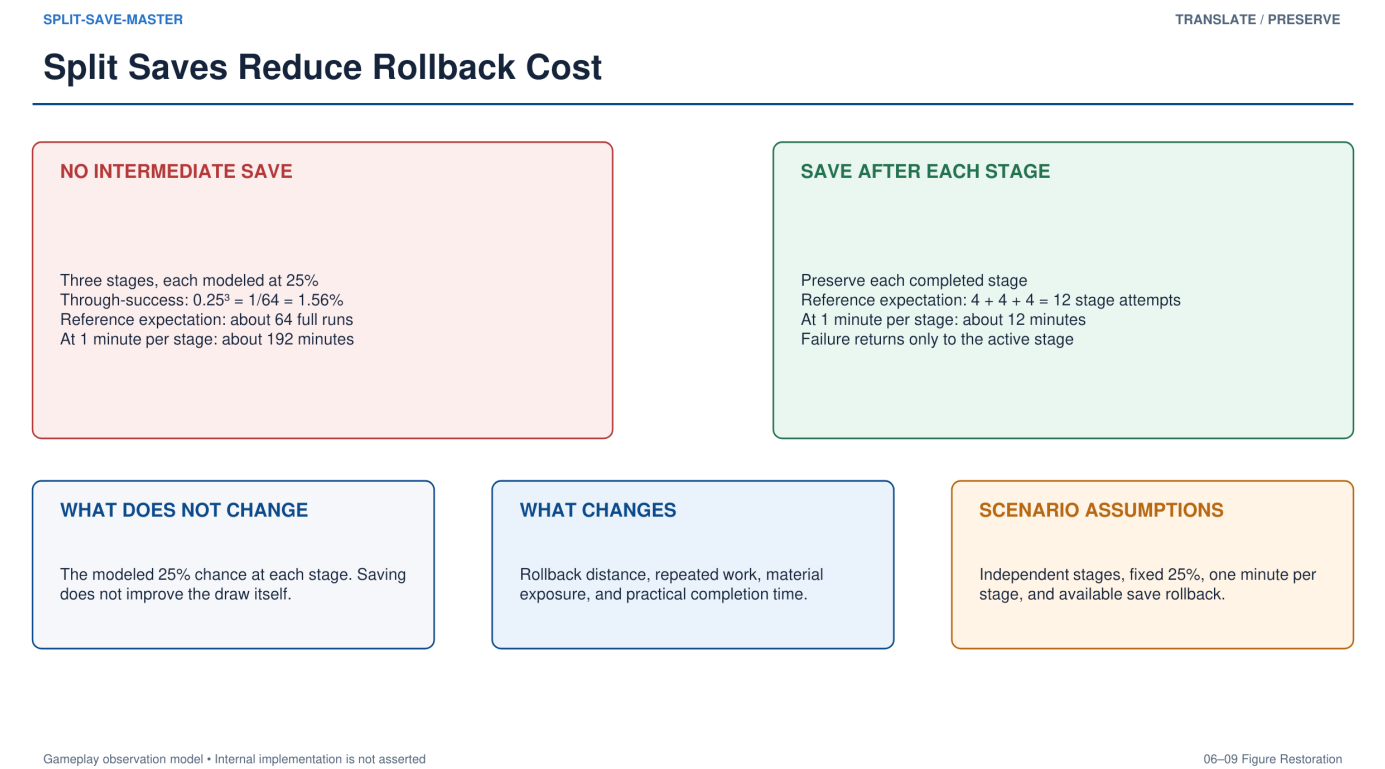
ONE-LINE SUMMARY For the protagonist, asymmetric results indicate that shield effectiveness under Messhilite inheritance may follow a property of the Performance Source weapon category rather than only the finished weapon's appearance category. Resident equipment must be treated separately.

Former understanding. This research initially understood that shield stats and resistances became ineffective whenever dual blades or fists were equipped in RF4SP and RF5. The earlier Chapter 09 therefore treated Object X and Mealy Apples in shoes or accessories as necessary support. Even after using free slots on other equipment for resistance, it treated approximately 97% to 99% as the practical range for dual-blade and fist builds, including an approximately 99% practical limit in RF5 when preserving headgear, because Invisible Stone cannot move the same function to headgear as in RF4SP.

Trigger for revision: external information. After these observations and alternative builds were shared with a knowledgeable creator who had published a dual-blades-and-shield example, the creator explained that protagonist shield reflection depends on the weapon category of the Messhilite Performance Source. For residents, the creator stated that the finished appearance category governs the result regardless of Messhilite arrangement, and that dragon-scale upgrades can allow dual blades and fists to receive 50% of shield stats and 100% of shield resistances.

The creator also explained that this was not a personal discovery but knowledge shared since the original 3DS release of RF4 through strategy guides, wikis, and specialist blogs. This testimony motivated the new test design. It is recorded separately from this project's in-game observations.

Direction tested for the protagonist	In-game result
Performance Source: Claymore; finished appearance: dual blades	Shield-derived effects were applied.
Performance Source: dual blades; finished appearance: one-handed sword	Shield-derived effects were not applied.



Placement caption

Split-save fixed-time comparison
Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.

BOUNDARY The directional tests were performed in RF4SP and RF5 for the protagonist. Resident-side rules and the historical provenance remain external information at this revision stage.

9-5-5A-1. Interpretation, Practical Update, and Evidence Boundary

ONE-LINE SUMMARY The practical recommendation changes, but the internal mechanism remains Unknown.

The directional asymmetry is compatible with an interpretation in which a property derived from the protagonist's Messhilite Performance Source category affects whether shield performance is effective. A finished dual-blade or fist appearance alone is not sufficient reason to declare shield performance unusable. Conversely, a dual-blade or fist Performance Source may prevent shield performance even when the finished appearance normally supports shields.

For the protagonist, selecting a shield-compatible category as the Performance Source can permit a dual-blade or fist appearance while retaining shield performance under the tested conditions. Resistance support through shoes or accessories remains a valid alternative when source-category constraints, shield-independent design, appearance, role-play, or manageability take priority.

Residents should be designed separately, considering the final appearance category and the reported dragon-scale interaction. The protagonist result must not be generalized directly to residents.

To avoid the warp effects of Ghost Boots or Rocket Wing, Object X + Mealy Apple + Step-In Boots (or Heavy Boots) is a practical handling-oriented alternative. Shoes and accessories still involve tradeoffs among internal arrangements, Performance-Source Contamination, and upgrade-slot competition.

Evidence layer	Current statement
Observation	In RF4SP and RF5 protagonist tests, Claymore source -> dual-blade appearance applied shield effects; dual-blade source -> one-handed-sword appearance did not.
External Information	Resident behavior reportedly follows final appearance category; dragon scales reportedly enable 50% shield stats and 100% shield resistances for dual blades/fists.
Historical Testimony	The provider stated that the rule had been shared since the 3DS RF4 era in guides, wikis, and specialist blogs; those historical sources were not individually checked for this revision.
Interpretation	A Performance-Source-category property is compatible with the protagonist asymmetry.
Unknown	Stored/reference information, reference timing, processing order, coverage across weapon categories, detailed resident processing, and exceptions.

BOUNDARY External information initiated the retest but is not upgraded into this project's in-game Observation. The in-game result does not prove an internal category-ID mechanism.

9-5-5B. Shoe Build Examples

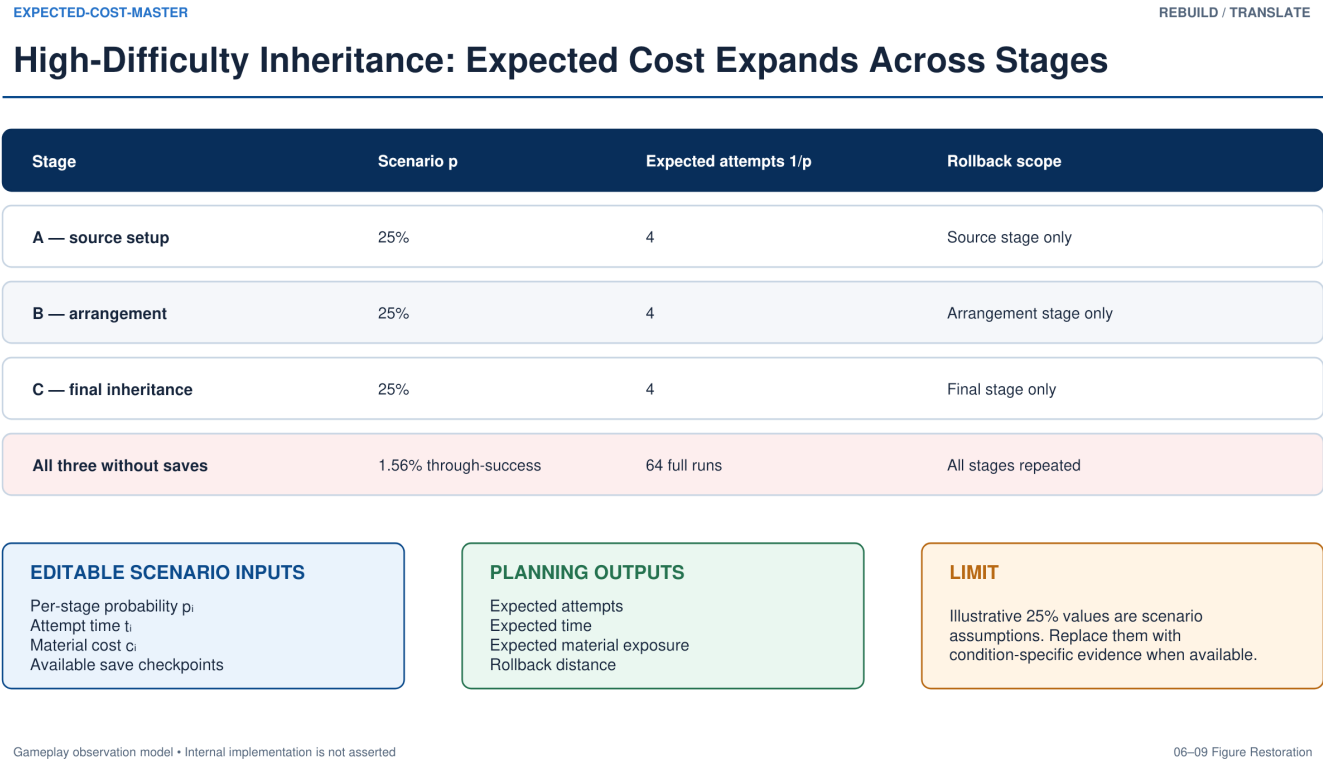
ONE-LINE SUMMARY Three shoe examples trade off stability, travel speed, handling, and construction burden.

The everyday build avoids excessive speed to preserve control. The speed build prioritizes long-distance collection and maze runs. The hobby build deliberately values enjoyment and high mobility over a single practical optimum.

Use	Appearance	Performance Source	Arrangement	Upgrade outline	Practical note
Everyday / general combat	Gold Boots	Heavy Boots	Strider Boots / Legendary Orc Cloth	Four colored cores -> optional Golden Scale -> Double Steel -> optional Dragonic Stone -> 2-Fold Steel -> free slot	Balanced combat, exploration, and farm work; stable and versatile; less suited to maximum-speed runs.
Maximum-speed runs	Sneaking Boots	Sneaking Boots	Ghost Boots / Rocket Wing	Four colored cores -> optional Golden Scale -> Double Steel -> optional Dragonic Stone -> 2-Fold Steel -> free slot	Excellent material and maze-run speed; reduced fine control and turning precision.
Hobby / dream build	Free	Heavy Boots	Ghost Boots / Rocket Wing / Strider Boots	Four colored cores -> optional Golden Scale -> Double Steel -> optional Dragonic Stone -> 2-Fold Steel -> free slot	Combines mobility and performance, but raises handling difficulty and selection burden.

Figure 09-P07-img-005

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Placement caption

Expected-value explosion model
Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.

9-5-5C. Accessory Build Examples

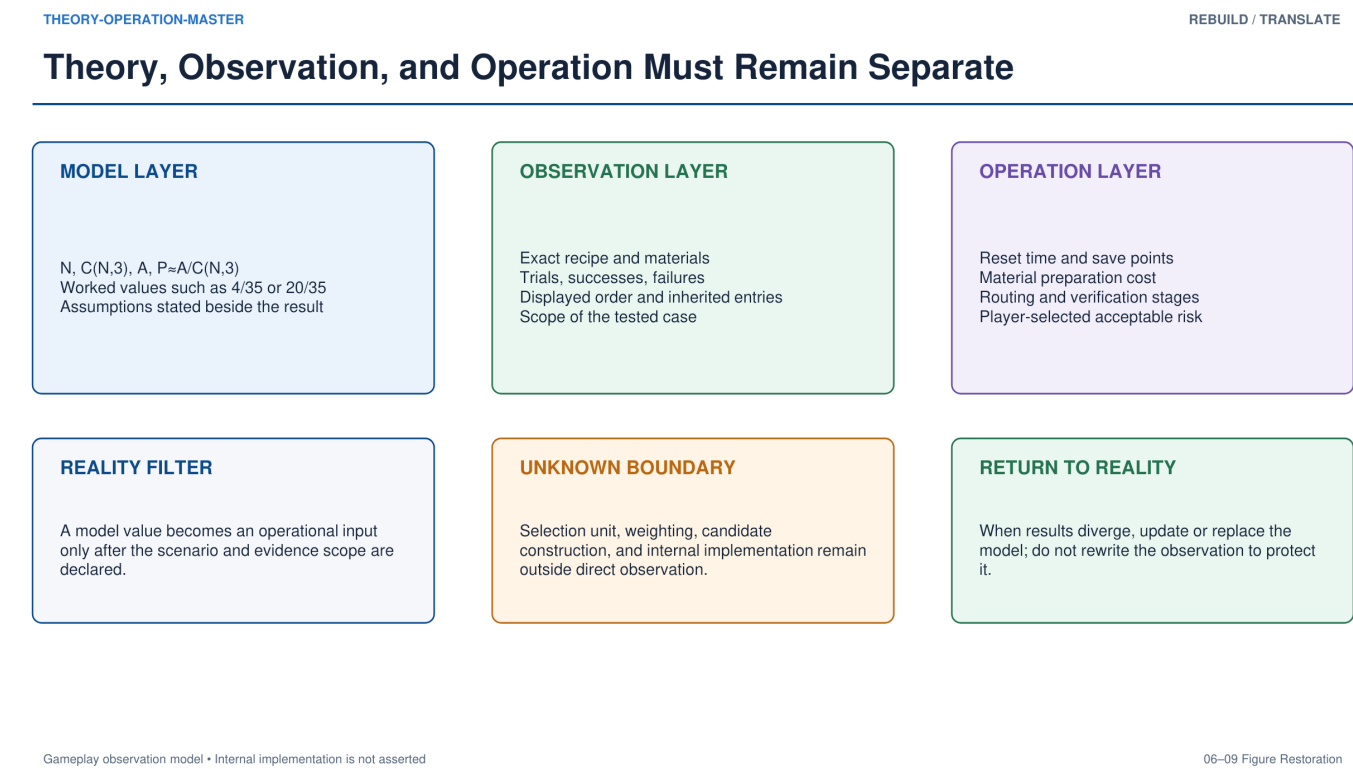
ONE-LINE SUMMARY Accessory sets are separated by task to reduce swapping confusion and to preserve practical reproducibility.

Combat accessories may carry Object X and Mealy Apples when resistance support is required. Collection, crafting, and other non-combat sets can use a lower practical resistance target to avoid the high acquisition cost of Mealy Apples.

Using approximately 100% or more in combat and approximately 80% or another sufficient line in daily operation is one possible use-case split. Keeping resistance values similar across frequently swapped sets can also reduce cognitive load.

Use	Appearance	Performance Source	Arrangement	Upgrade outline	Practical note
General combat	Magic Mastery	Magic Mastery	Proof of Wisdom / Magic Ring	Four colored cores -> Tablet of Truth -> Double Steel -> Object X -> Mealy Apple -> Mealy Apple	Difficult combat and RP management; non-elemental resistance and charge reduction; less specialized for runs.
Fast runs	Rosary	Rosary	Annette's Necklace / Talisman	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Enemy removal and movement speed; strong for exploration, not boss combat. Talisman also raises speed after drinking Object X.
Rare Can / wanted-monster collection	Magic Ring	Magic Ring	Rosary / Proof of Wisdom	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Faster charging for collection routes, Baked Sweet Potato staff/fishing-rod inheritance, and SEED Circle use.
Crafting	Work Gloves or Focus Earrings	Talisman	Fluffy Scarf / Hand-Knit Scarf	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Long crafting through RP-cost reduction and fatigue reversal; intended for bulk Turnip Heaven or Gold Juice production. The two scarves and fatigue reversal were observed to stack.
Skill training	Heart Pendant	Heart Pendant	Fluffy Scarf / Proof of Wisdom	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Prioritizes skill experience and long training sessions over peak damage.
Leveling	Star Pendant	Star Pendant	Tetsuya Ring / Proof of Strength	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Experience-oriented, with all-nighter bonuses and percentage recovery for extended hunting.
Item collection	Heart Pendant	Heart Pendant	Fluffy Scarf / Proof of Wisdom	Four colored cores -> five free slots	Prioritizes common-drop support from clover-type effects and works with SEED Circle or hold-skill training.
Hobby / dream build	Champion Belt	Champion Belt	Proof of Strength / Proof of Wisdom	Four colored cores -> five free slots	HP increase and automatic recovery; a role-play or novelty build whose practical value depends on the rest of the setup.

BOUNDARY These are practical examples, not universally optimal recipes. Some item-name translations may differ from official localization wording.



Placement caption

Theory versus operational success model
Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.

9-6. Practical-Operation Philosophy

ONE-LINE SUMMARY High-difficulty inheritance should separate what is theoretically possible from what is realistically sustainable and should evaluate several optimization axes at once.

Success probability, work time, mental load, reset count, and long-term usability cannot be represented by numerical performance alone. The theoretical optimum, practical optimum, hobby build, and compromise build may each be appropriate in a different context.

High-difficulty inheritance is also connected to world-building, character identity, construction philosophy, and play style. What counts as optimal can therefore differ from player to player.

This chapter does not force theory, practical operation, and role-play into one ranking. It treats multiple optimization axes as simultaneously valid.

- Theoretical optimum
- Practical optimum
- Hobby / dream build
- Compromise build

Translation and Authority Boundary

This English edition translates and reconstructs the revised Japanese Chapter 09 available in the project workspace. The revised Japanese chapter remains the source for research review. This English edition does not silently upgrade practical interpretation, external information, historical testimony, or Unknown internal mechanisms into confirmed game specifications.

Figure 09-P11-img-007

Master: HIGH-DIFFICULTY-REQUIREMENTS | Source anchor: Japanese Canonical p.11



Placement caption

High-difficulty equipment/material requirement table
Evidence boundary: the figure separates Observation, Model, and Unknown Transition as applicable.